

take-home pay to savings. Also, don't allow your monthly debt payments (not including your mortgage) to exceed 20% of your monthly take-home pay—or your *total* debt (not including your mortgage or student loans) to exceed 20% of your *annual* take-home pay.

- **Gain control of your finances by setting up a filing system and developing regular bill-paying habits. And if you're having trouble controlling your spending, consider a site like www.mint.com or www.quickenonline.com, which can help you keep track of it.**
- **Automate your savings by having a certain amount siphoned from your paycheck each month.**